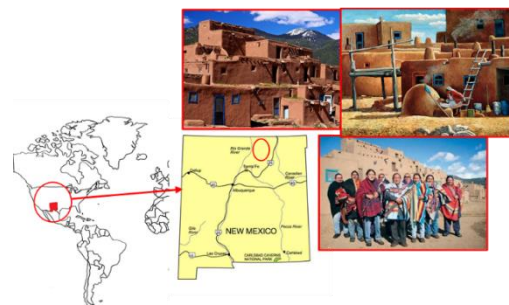


The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2022 - Round 2

Problem 5. Taos (25 marks)

Taos is a Tanoan language spoken by about 800 people in New Mexico.

Below are some sentences in Taos and their English translations. Note that **a**, **e**, **i**, **o** and **u** are nasal vowels, while **p**, **t** and **y** are consonants. Taos is a tonal language, but here tones have been omitted for simplicity. Note also that here “deer” is used exclusively to refer to one deer, while “deers” is used to refer to multiple deers.



Taos	English
kimpɛnemə ipihumɔ	<i>Our deers saw the cedar.</i>
kəkana pɛxi	<i>Your mother waited for the deer.</i>
imhɔnemə t'oymət'ɛ	<i>Their cedar hit the person.</i>
iwkine iwp'imət'ɛ	<i>Their blankets hit the heads.</i>
kip'oyna ip'jwxi	<i>Our brother waited for the sparrows.</i>
kəwcine ip'oymɔ	<i>Your eyes saw the brother.</i>
t'oyna ikixi	<i>The person waited for the blanket.</i>
kanemə ip'jwmət'ɛ	<i>The mothers hit the sparrow.</i>
əmcinemə ip'oymɔ	<i>His eye saw the brothers.</i>
əmp'oynemə iwcimɔ	<i>His brothers saw the eyes.</i>
kine ipipɛmət'ɛ	<i>The blankets hit the deers.</i>

5.1) Translate the following into English:

- imt'oynemə iwhumɔ**
- əpɛna kamət'ɛ**
- əwhɔne ipit'oymət'ɛ**
- p'jwnemə ipipɛxi**

5.2) Translate the following into Taos:

- Your sparrows waited for the mothers.*
- The heads saw the blanket.*
- Our eyes saw the heads.*
- Their deer waited for the brother.*

5.3) Explain your solution.

NB: some of the Taos sentences above would be considered odd by a native Taos speaker, who would use a passive construction instead. For simplicity, an active construction has been used here in all cases.